Premium Cycling Lifestyle Brand

Three creative directions — research, identity, website and matching email for each.

Joseph R. Benipayo · Concept study · 30 October 2026

Lists:

Research board — Rapha, MAAP, luxury references

Wind Breaker — visual-language notes

01 — ORDRE · Luxury minimalist cycling

02 — SLIPSTREAM · Manga-inspired crew streetwear (black and white)

03 — 0500 · Dawn riding for hot cities (my direction)

Comparison, ratings and recommendation

How this was made

Research. Live brand websites were opened in a desktop browser (1440 × 900) and captured as screenshots on 30 October 2026. Email references come from Email Love's published descriptions, with links. All captured images belong to their brands and are used here as research references only.

Designs. All six designs are real HTML pages, rendered in Chromium at desktop (1440 px for websites, 680 px for emails) and mobile (390 px) widths. Each render was checked for horizontal overflow on mobile. Emails are built as 600 px table layouts with live text, inline styles and an unsubscribe footer; they have *not* been tested in Gmail or Outlook.

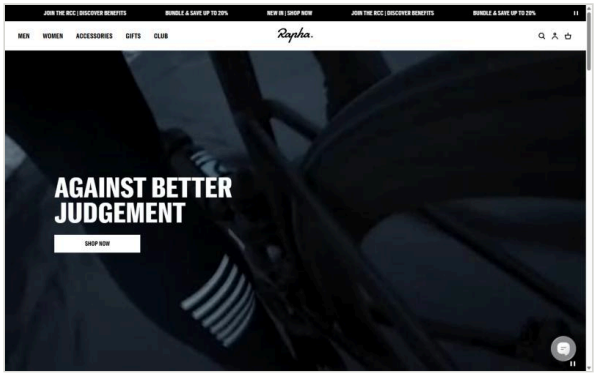
Imagery. Lifestyle and bicycle photography in all three concepts is real photography from Unsplash, used under the Unsplash License (free for commercial and non-commercial use; credits on the last page). Logos, emblems, crew glyphs and apparel tech flats are original artwork drawn for this study. Prices, weights and lab figures in the mockups are illustrative placeholders, not tested claims.

Limits. Captures stopped partway because the browser on your computer was minimised, so the board has Rapha and MAAP but not Pas Normal Studios, Café du Cycliste or the luxury fashion houses. Email Love's human-verification page was not cleared, so no email screenshots are included.

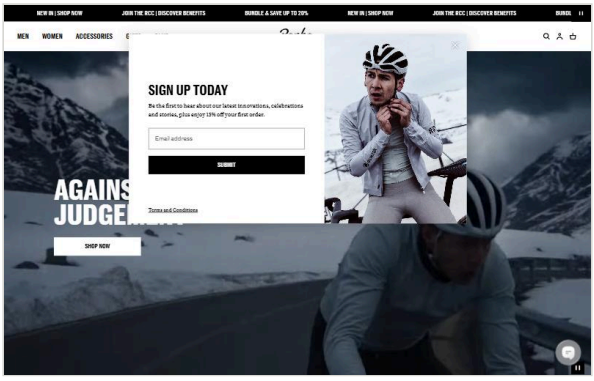
RESEARCH BOARD · CYCLING

Rapha

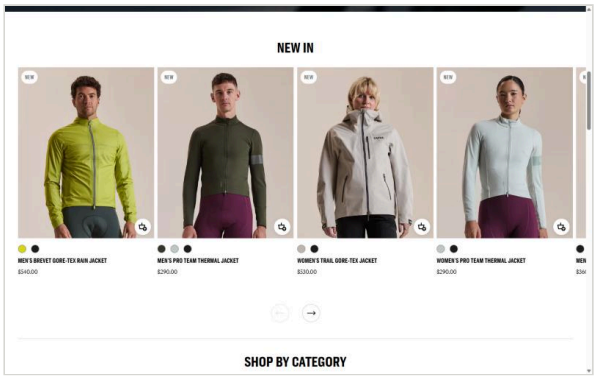
rapha.cc · Homepage captured 30 Oct 2026 · research reference only



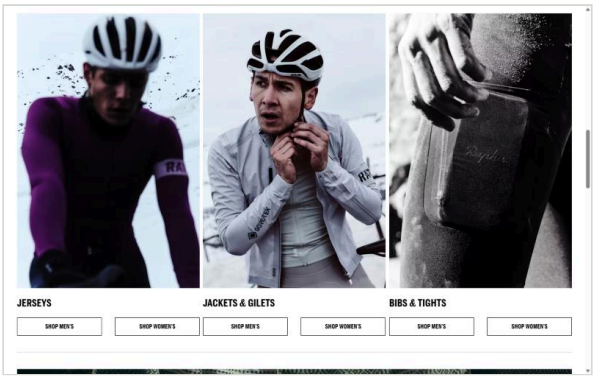
Hero: video, condensed caps headline, one white button



First visit: 15% off for an email address



New In: studio product shots, swatches, quick-add



Shop by category: portrait tiles, Men's / Women's split

Ticker bar rotates three messages: New In, the RCC membership, and a bundle offer. Commerce and community share one strip.

Hero is cinematic video (snow, mountain road) with a heavy condensed caps line, "Against Better Judgement", and one white Shop Now button.

Email capture interrupts the first visit with a 15% discount. Effective, but it is the opposite of a quiet luxury entrance.

Product photography is consistent: models on a warm grey sweep, colour swatches and a quick-add icon on every card.

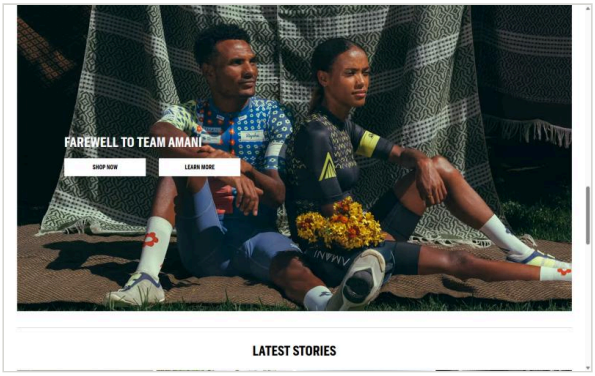
Category tiles are campaign photos, not product shots, with paired Men's / Women's buttons under each.

> **Learn:** one photographic system for products (same sweep, same crop) makes a large range feel premium. Used in all three concepts.

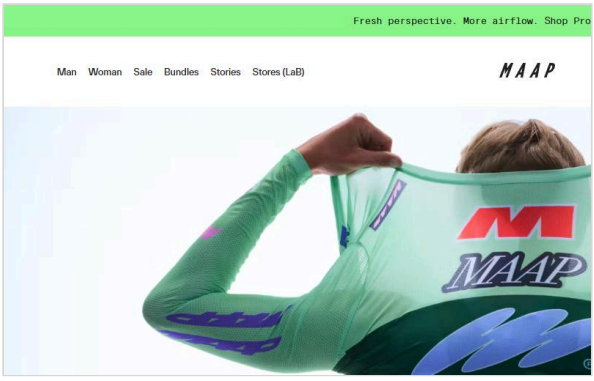
RESEARCH BOARD · CYCLING

Rapha (team kit) · MAAP

rapha.cc · maap.cc · captured 30 Oct 2026 · research reference only



Rapha: 'Farewell to Team Amani' kit story



MAAP: hero built on the jersey's own graphics

Rapha's team story sells a team's kit through the team itself: its patterns, its riders, its farewell. This is the strongest evidence that a *crew identity* can carry commerce (Concept 02).

MAAP's hero is a jersey's back, logo-as-pattern: a big "M", the italic MAAP wordmark and a cobalt swoosh. The garment is the billboard.

MAAP's announcement bar uses a bright green with monospace type, which reads technical and youthful at once.

MAAP's product lines are named like platforms (Pro Air, Training, Aeon, Pro Aero) rather than seasons, which scales well.

Cross-references from earlier research

Reference	What we saw	Used in
Aman (batch 1)	One card formula everywhere: caps label, serif title, two lines, text link. Warm off-white, one button per screen.	01 ORDRE
Four Seasons (batch 1)	Pinned booking bar; black-and-white system; heritage band in black.	01, 03
Rosewood (batch 1)	One italic word in serif headlines; one accent colour reserved for the booking button.	01 ORDRE
Hermès email (Email Love)	Panel tints pulled from the hero; one contrast tile; hairline button.	01 email
Louis Vuitton email (Email Love)	Full-bleed image, short paragraph, two-up grid, black footer as a "back cover".	01, 03 emails
Four Seasons email (Email Love)	Dark header; destination stories in repeated image + text blocks.	03 email

REFERENCE STUDY

Wind Breaker — visual-language notes

Korean road-cycling webtoon by Yongseok Jo · Naver Webtoon, 2013–2025 · no images reproduced

Status. Naver Webtoon suspended the series on 11 July 2025 after the author admitted tracing some character designs from *Tokyo Ghoul*; Naver announced refunds on 19 July 2025. The brand should take general genre principles from it and never reference it by name.

What makes the crews recognisable (my reading of the genre)

Crews as identity. The story is organised around named crews (the protagonist's Hummingbird Crew, rival crews such as Monster and Trident). A rider is read through the crew first, the person second.

One mark, everywhere. A crew is carried by a small repeatable emblem on chest, sleeve, helmet and bike, so a single glance identifies the team, even at speed.

Numbers and stats. Race numbers, speeds and climb stats appear as graphic elements, giving sport its "game" layer.

Street, not stadium. Races happen on city roads and night streets, with streetwear off the bike, which is why cycling reads as youth culture rather than a lycra sport.

Motion as drawing. Speed lines, diagonal panel splits and low camera angles make stillness feel fast.

Principles extracted → applied in Concept 02 (original assets only)

Genre principle	Original SLIPSTREAM translation
Named crews	Three crews — APEX (climbers), NIGHTSHIFT (city racers), TAILWIND (sprinters) — each with a colour, a glyph and a weekly ride
Small emblem = recognition	Hex-07 badge plus geometric crew glyphs (triangle, crescent, three slashes) that work at 20 px on a sleeve
Numbers	Kit numbers 01–03, Drop 07, season and stage counters in the navigation
Panels and motion	Hero and "Chapter" sections built as comic grids with speed lines and halftone, using our own product art
Story	Every collection ships with an original short "chapter"; the newsletter is "get the next chapter first"

I did not use the panels or crew logos from the series, or edited versions of them: they belong to the author and publisher, and a commercial brand built on them would be exposed both legally and, given the plagiarism history, reputationally.

STRATEGY

Three directions at a glance

Three different philosophies, not three colourways

	01 · ORDRE	02 · SLIPSTREAM	03 · 0500
Idea	Cycling as craftsmanship. A Paris atelier making few garments, properly.	Cycling as team sport and street culture. Pick a crew, ride for it.	Cycling as a daily ritual before sunrise in hot cities.
Customer	35–55, high income, rides fast group rides, buys Loro Piana off the bike	18–30, Seoul / Tokyo / Manila, rides at night with friends, buys drops	25–45 urban professionals in Manila, Taipei, Singapore, Bangkok who ride 05:00–07:30
Personality	Quiet, precise, unhurried	Loud, competitive, funny	Calm, technical, local
Type	GFS Baskerville + Inter	Inter Display Black (italic, skewed) + Noto Sans CJK + mono	Inter + DejaVu Sans Mono (instrument readouts)
Colour	Ivory, bone, charcoal, olive, clay	Ink and paper only, with screentone greys	Pre-dawn navy, sodium amber, dawn pink, concrete
Logo	Circle cut by a horizon line + spaced wordmark	Hex-07 badge + three crew glyphs	"5OO0": the zeros are wheels, a sun rises between them
Website	Editorial, product-first, one button per screen	Manga-page hero, screentoned photos, crew stat sheets, numbered drops	Live sunrise / temp readout, kit specs, city loops
Email	"Performance without compromise" collection letter	"Join the crew" team collection launch	"The Sunrise Report" weekly, with Kit 05 launch
Price tier	High luxury (jersey € 245)	Premium streetwear (jersey ₩ 189,000)	Premium performance (jersey ₱ 6,450)

CONCEPT 01 · LUXURY MINIMALIST

ORDRE

"Performance, in its quietest form." · Paris atelier · high luxury

Concept statement

A European cycling atelier that treats a jersey like tailoring: fourteen pieces a collection, 300 units a colour, free repairs for life, no discounts. Luxury is expressed through restraint, materials and service, not logos.

Target audience

Experienced riders aged 35–55 who already own a good bike and want kit that matches the rest of their wardrobe. They value repair, fit and rarity over novelty.

Photography direction

Studio product on bone-coloured sweep; landscapes at first light with tiny riders; no action blur. (Shown here with Unsplash photography; apparel shown as tech flats.)

Identity



The monogram is a circle (a wheel, a medal) cut by a horizon line: precision and the road ahead. It works embossed on a zip pull or as a 16 px favicon.

Typography

Performance, *without compromise.*

INTER · SMALL CAPS LABELS · 0.18EM TRACKING

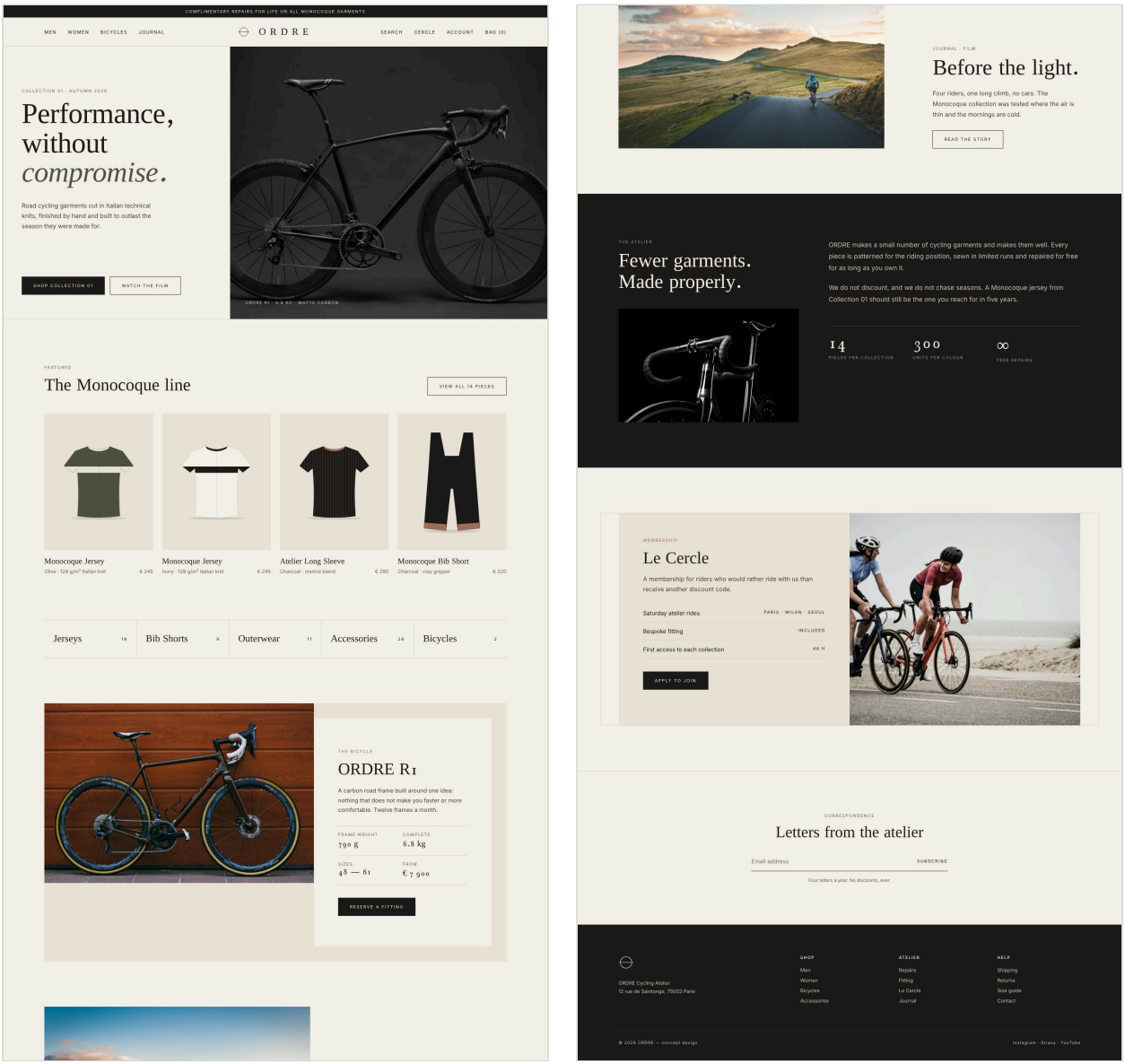
Website and email direction

Editorial grid, one button per screen, italic accent word (from Rosewood), card formula (from Aman). The email reads like a letter from the atelier.

Ivory	Bone	Warm grey	Charcoal	Olive	Clay
#F4F0E8	#E8E2D6	#9B958A	#1C1B19	#4E5340	#A0715A

CONCEPT 01 · LUXURY MINIMALIST · WEBSITE · DESKTOP 1440 PX

ORDRE — homepage



Full homepage, rendered in Chromium at 1440 px (left: top half, right: bottom half)

Hero: split layout, serif headline with olive italic, beside a dark studio photograph of the bicycle. Says "premium cycling" within one second.

Featured line: four products on identical sweeps, name, fabric and price; no badges, no sale tags.

Category bar: five large serif links with item counts, the fastest route into the catalogue.

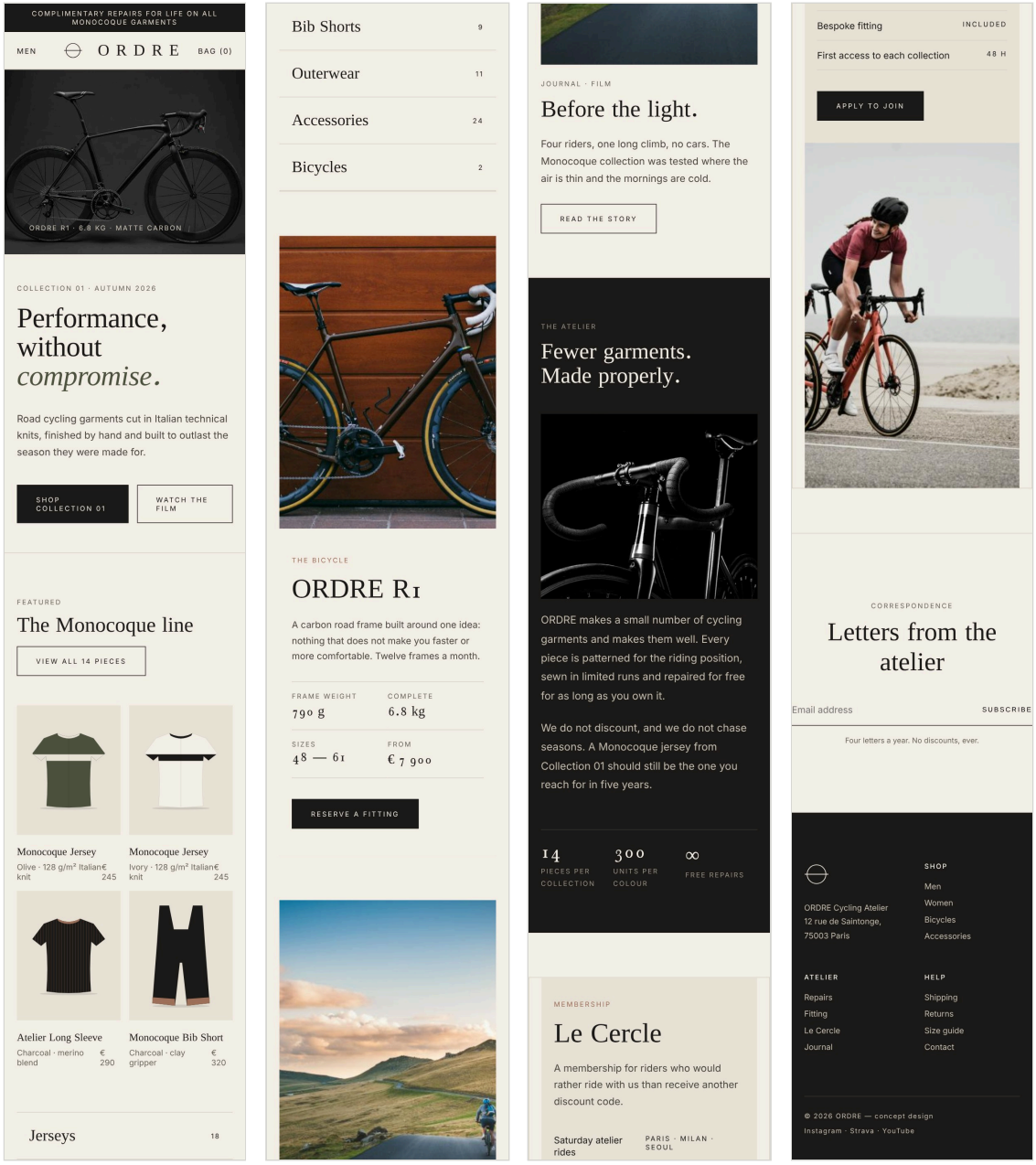
Bicycle: spec card with four numbers and one action, "Reserve a fitting".

Editorial: "Before the light", a journal entry with a mountain-road photograph, tied to the collection.

Atelier story in charcoal with three proof numbers; **Le Cercle** membership with real benefits; four-letters-a-year newsletter; quiet charcoal footer.

CONCEPT 01 · LUXURY MINIMALIST · WEBSITE · MOBILE 390 PX

ORDRE — mobile homepage

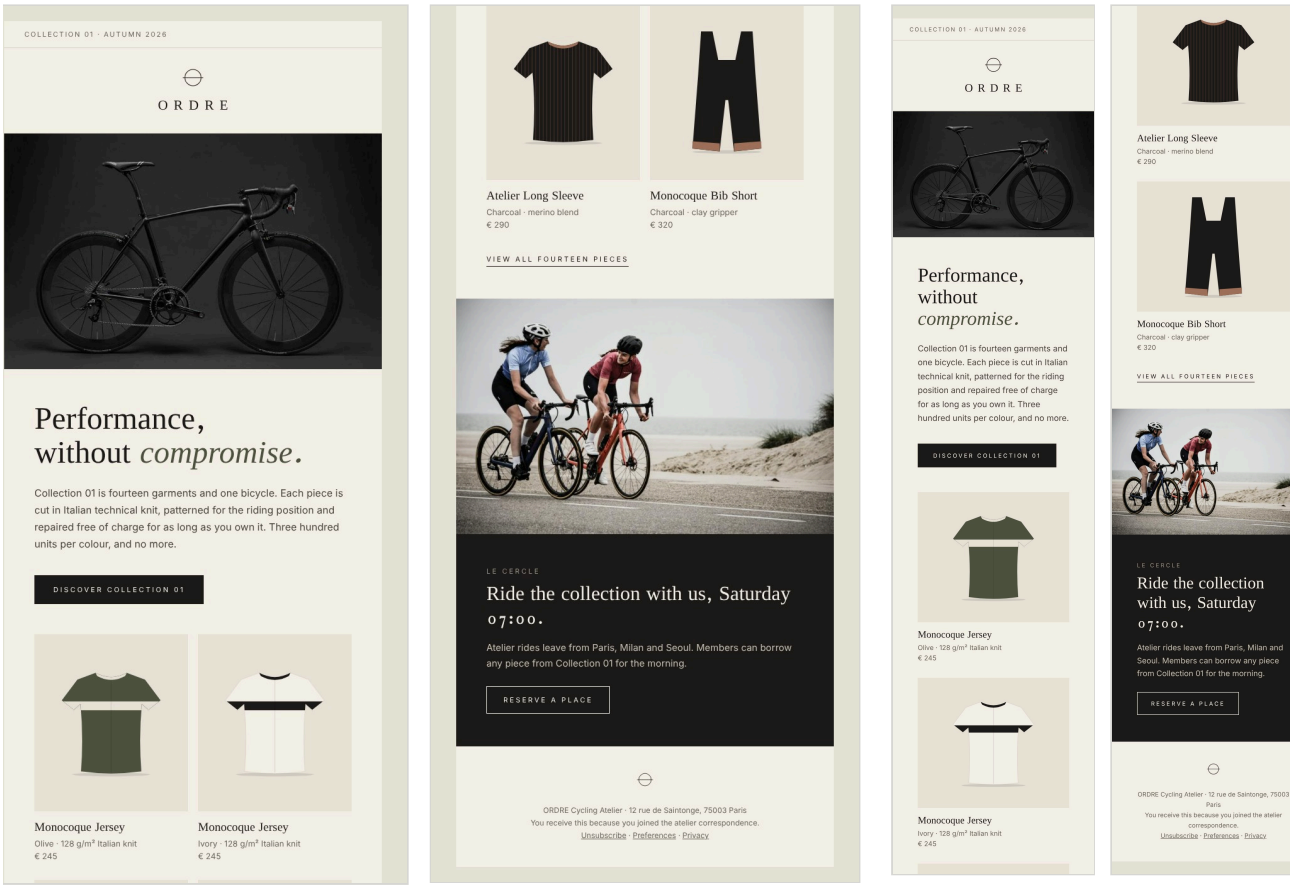


Homepage at 390 px mobile, full scroll in four strips (no horizontal overflow)

On mobile the hero image moves above the headline, products drop to two columns and the category bar becomes a list. Navigation collapses to the first and last link.

CONCEPT 01 · LUXURY MINIMALIST · EMAIL · 600 PX

ORDRE — matching email



Desktop client (680 px window), two halves

Mobile 390 px

Same system as the site: ivory background, Baskerville headline with the olive italic, Inter caps labels, charcoal CTA.

Structure: monogram header → hero bicycle → headline → 3-line intro → one CTA → 2×2 products with descriptions and prices → Le Cercle ride block → footer with address and unsubscribe.

Email-safe build: 600 px table, live text, preheader, Georgia/Arial fallbacks for Outlook. Product art would ship as 2× PNGs with alt text; the hero has an accessible label.

CONCEPT 02 · MANGA-INSPIRED · BLACK AND WHITE

SLIPSTREAM

"Pick a side. Ride for it." · Seoul · Tokyo · Manila · premium streetwear · v2: pure ink and paper

Concept statement

A crew-based cycling apparel brand that looks like a printed manga volume. You don't just buy a jersey, you join a crew: its glyph, its weekly ride, its stat sheet and the next chapter of an original story that ships with every collection.

Why black and white

The first version used orange, volt and cobalt and read as loud. Manga is printed in one ink: drama comes from panels, screentone, speed lines and lettering, not colour. Removing colour also makes the brand feel more premium and lets photography and type carry it.

Photography direction

Real riding photos converted into manga screentone (dot tones for greys, hatching for shadows, inked edges), so every photo looks drawn and every panel matches. Night streets, sprints and bunches, never studio-clean.

Target audience

18–30 riders in Asian capitals who ride at night with friends and buy streetwear drops.

Identity



Hex-07 badge plus three crew glyphs (triangle, crescent, three slashes), all single-colour so they print on any jersey, sleeve or helmet.

Manga toolkit

4 px ink panel borders · black caption boxes · speech balloons for crew chat · narration boxes in mono · Japanese sound effects (シュン, ゴォ) outlined in ink · vertical katakana tag クルーに入れ ("join the crew") · speed-line and dot-tone fills.

Typography

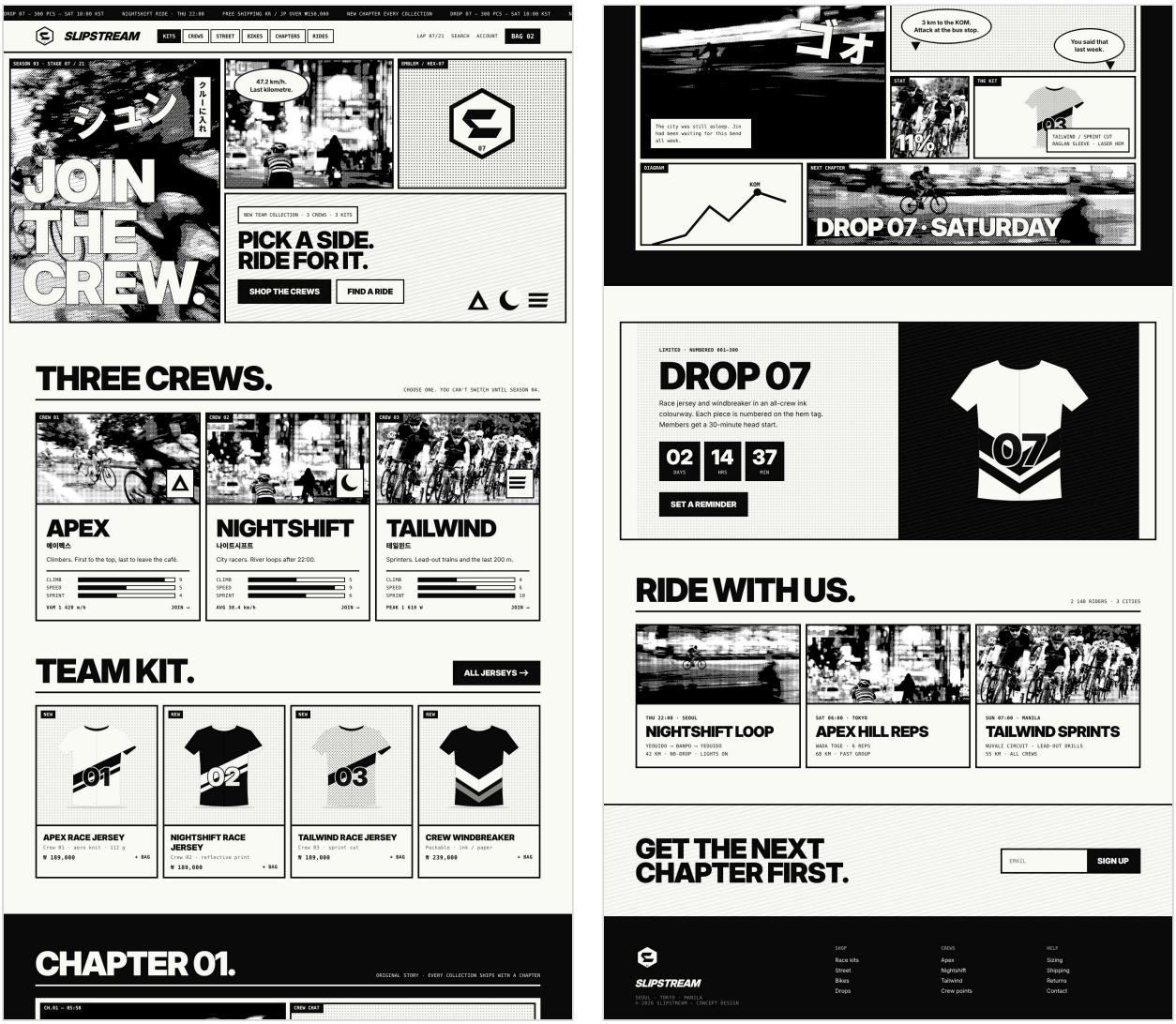
JOIN THE CREW. クルーに入れ

MONO · STATS · STAGE 07/21

Ink	Paper	Tone grey
#0A0A0A	#FAFAF7	#8a8a86

CONCEPT 02 · MANGA-INSPIRED · BLACK AND WHITE · WEBSITE · DESKTOP 1440 PX

SLIPSTREAM — homepage



Full homepage, rendered in Chromium at 1440 px (left: top half, right: bottom half)

Hero as a manga page: a screentoned sprint with an outlined "JOIN THE CREW." and a シュン sound effect; a night-street panel with a speech balloon; the emblem on dot tone; the pitch panel with two CTAs.

Crew cards: each crew gets its own screentoned photo (sprint for Apex, night street for Nightshift, bunch for Tailwind), its glyph and a manga-style stat sheet (climb, speed, sprint).

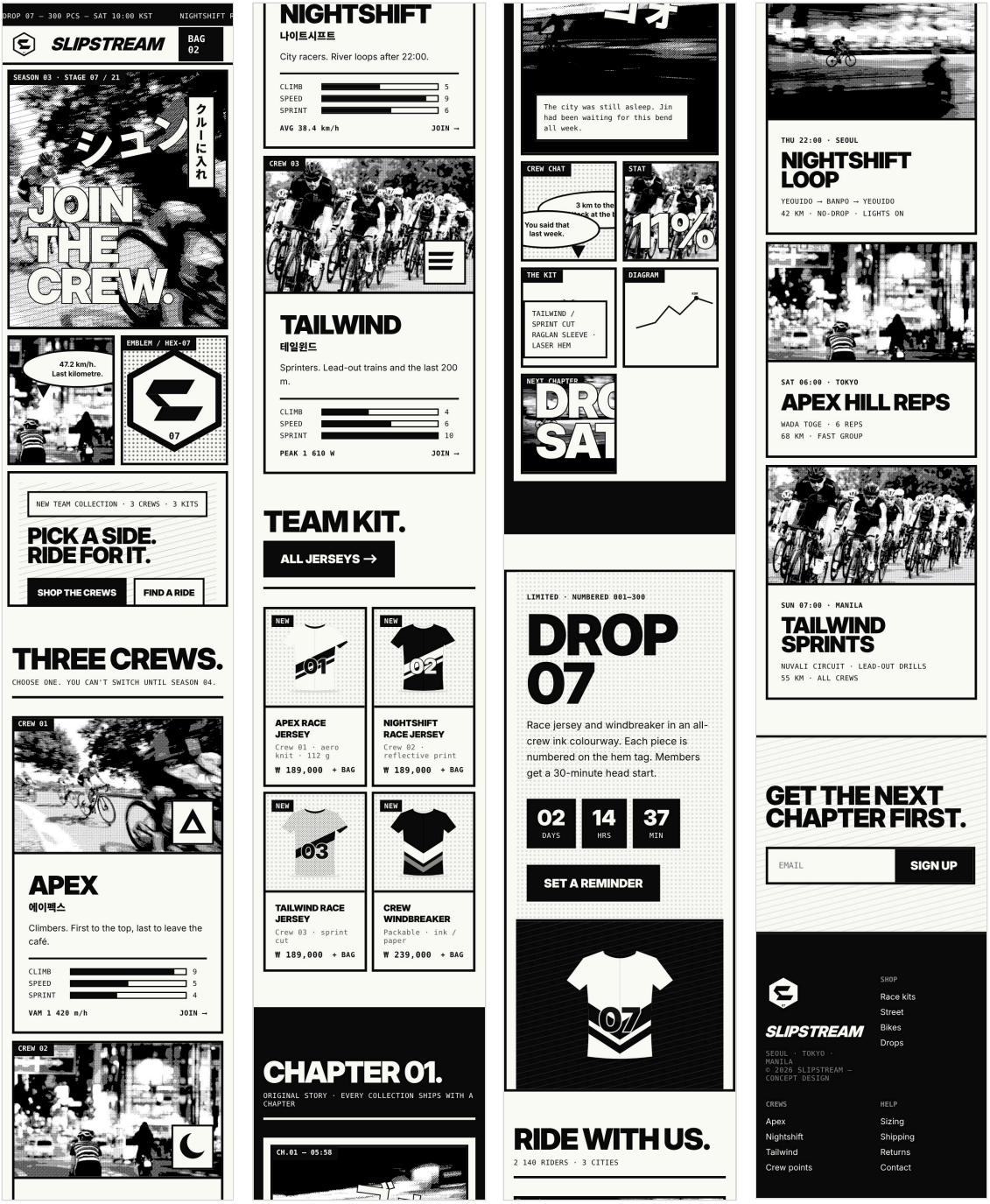
Team kit: four black-and-white jerseys (slash, dot-tone, chevron) on paper with a light dot tone; numbers keep a paper outline so they read through the stripe.

Chapter 01: a full comic spread: narration box, crew chat in balloons, a stat panel, the kit, a KOM diagram and a "Drop 07 · Saturday" panel.

Drop 07 countdown in ink; **Ride with us** cards with screentoned photos; speed-line newsletter band; ink footer.

CONCEPT 02 · MANGA-INSPIRED · BLACK AND WHITE · WEBSITE · MOBILE 390 PX

SLIPSTREAM — mobile homepage

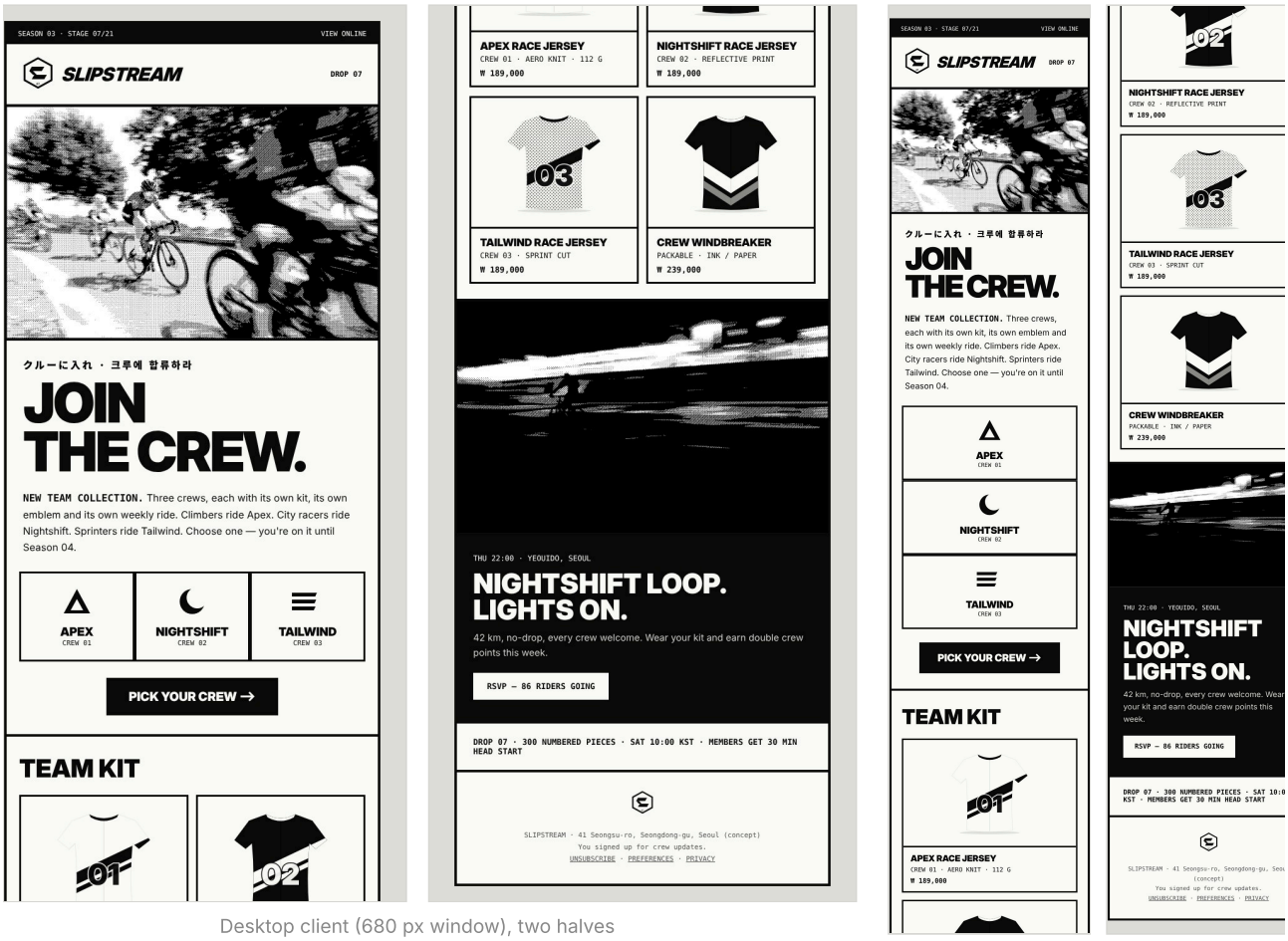


Homepage at 390 px mobile, full scroll in four strips (no horizontal overflow)

On mobile the hero restacks as a manga page: the large sprint panel first, then the balloon and emblem panels side by side, then the pitch. Crews, kit and the chapter spread stack into readable panels with no horizontal overflow.

CONCEPT 02 · MANGA-INSPIRED · BLACK AND WHITE · EMAIL · 600 PX

SLIPSTREAM — matching email



Desktop client (680 px window), two halves

Mobile 390 px

Matches the site: same screentoned sprint as the hero, bilingual line (クルーに入れ · 크루에 합류하라), ink borders, black CTA, crew glyph tiles.

Structure: stage bar → logo row → screentone hero image → "Join the crew" → collection story → three crew tiles → "Pick your crew" → 2×2 team kit → night-ride image → Nightshift RSVP → Drop 07 bar → footer.

Email-safe: the screentone is baked into the photos (plain JPGs), so it survives every email client; all copy is live text. CJK lines fall back to system fonts.

CONCEPT 03 · SENIOR CREATIVE DIRECTION

0500

"Ride before the city wakes." · Manila first, then Taipei, Singapore, Bangkok · premium performance

1 · Market opportunity

Premium cycling brands are designed around European weather. On the day of research, Rapha's homepage, shown to a visitor from "Rest of Asia", led with snow and thermal jackets. In Manila, Taipei, Singapore and Bangkok, serious riders start around 05:00 to beat 34°C heat and traffic. Nobody owns that ritual.

2 · Inspired by

MAAP's technical-graphic confidence, Four Seasons' booking clarity, Aman's calm, Rapha's community rides, and instrument and motorsport timing graphics.

3 · Avoided on purpose

Alpine snow heroes, black-on-black "moody luxury", faux-vintage wool, logo-heavy hype drops.

4 · What's distinctive

Time and climate are the brand: sunrise times, temperatures, humidity and loops are live content, and the product is tested against heat, not cold.

Identity



"5OO0": read as 05:00; the two zeros are wheels and a sun rises between them.

5 · Customer

25–45 professionals who ride before work, three to four times a week, and want kit that dries fast and keeps them visible in the dark.

6 · Commercial position

Between Rapha and mid-market: ₱ 6,450 jerseys, ₱ 8,900 bibs. Launch in Manila with the First Light Club, expand city by city with local loops.

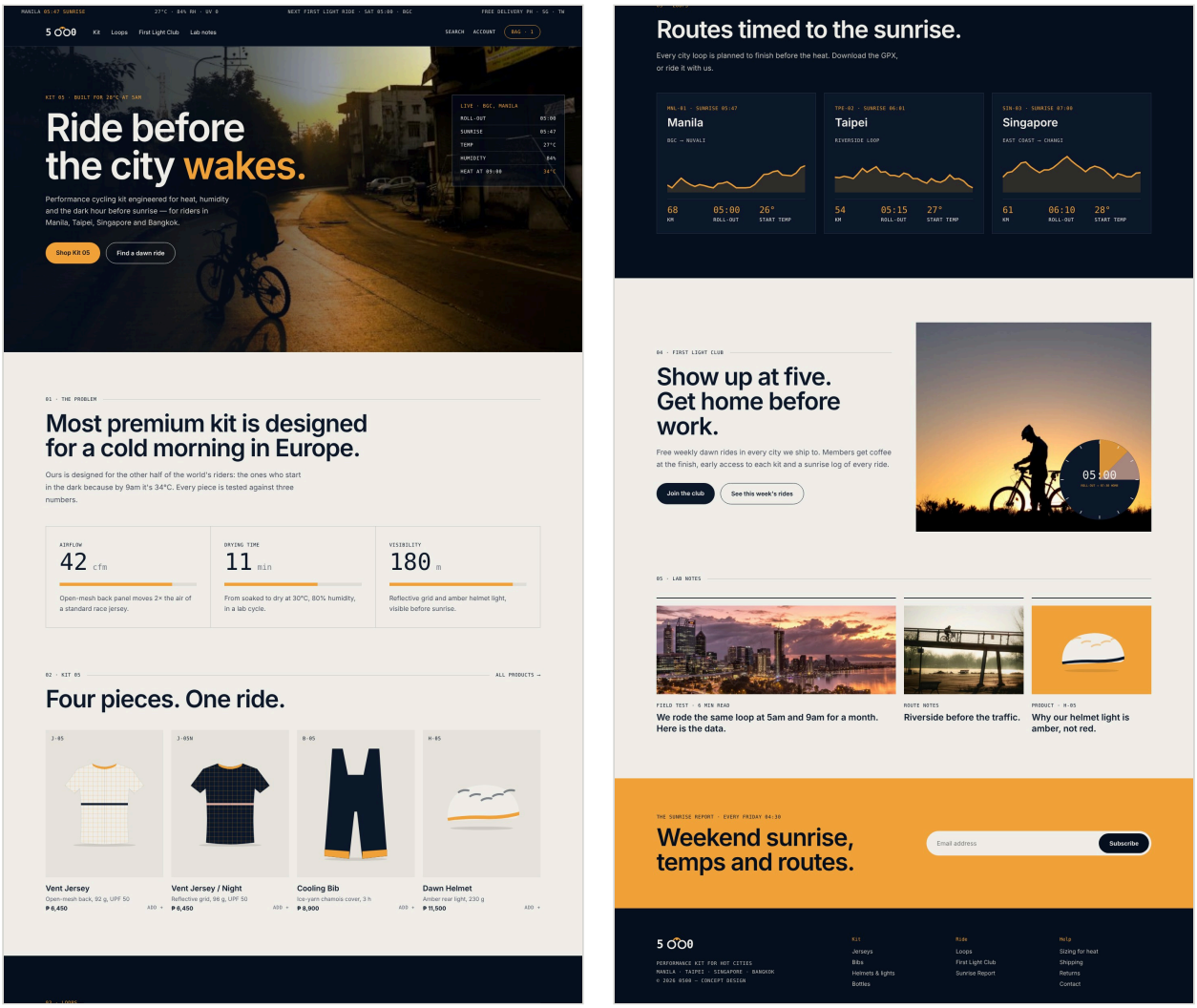
7 · Why site and email work together

Both are built on the same data: the site's live readout becomes the email's weekly sunrise table, and the site's loops become the email's route of the week.

Pre-dawn navy	Night	Sodium amber	Dawn	Concrete	Paper
#0E1A2B	#081120	#F2A33A	#E9B6A6	#C9C6BF	#F1EFEA

CONCEPT 03 · SENIOR CREATIVE DIRECTION · WEBSITE · DESKTOP 1440 PX

0500 — homepage



Full homepage, rendered in Chromium at 1440 px (left: top half, right: bottom half)

Status bar: sunrise, temperature, humidity and the next club ride, so the brand's subject is clear in the first line.

Hero: sunrise street photograph with a navy fade for legibility, "Ride before the city wakes.", plus a live readout panel.

The problem: three instruments (airflow, drying time, visibility) with gauges; figures are placeholders until lab-tested.

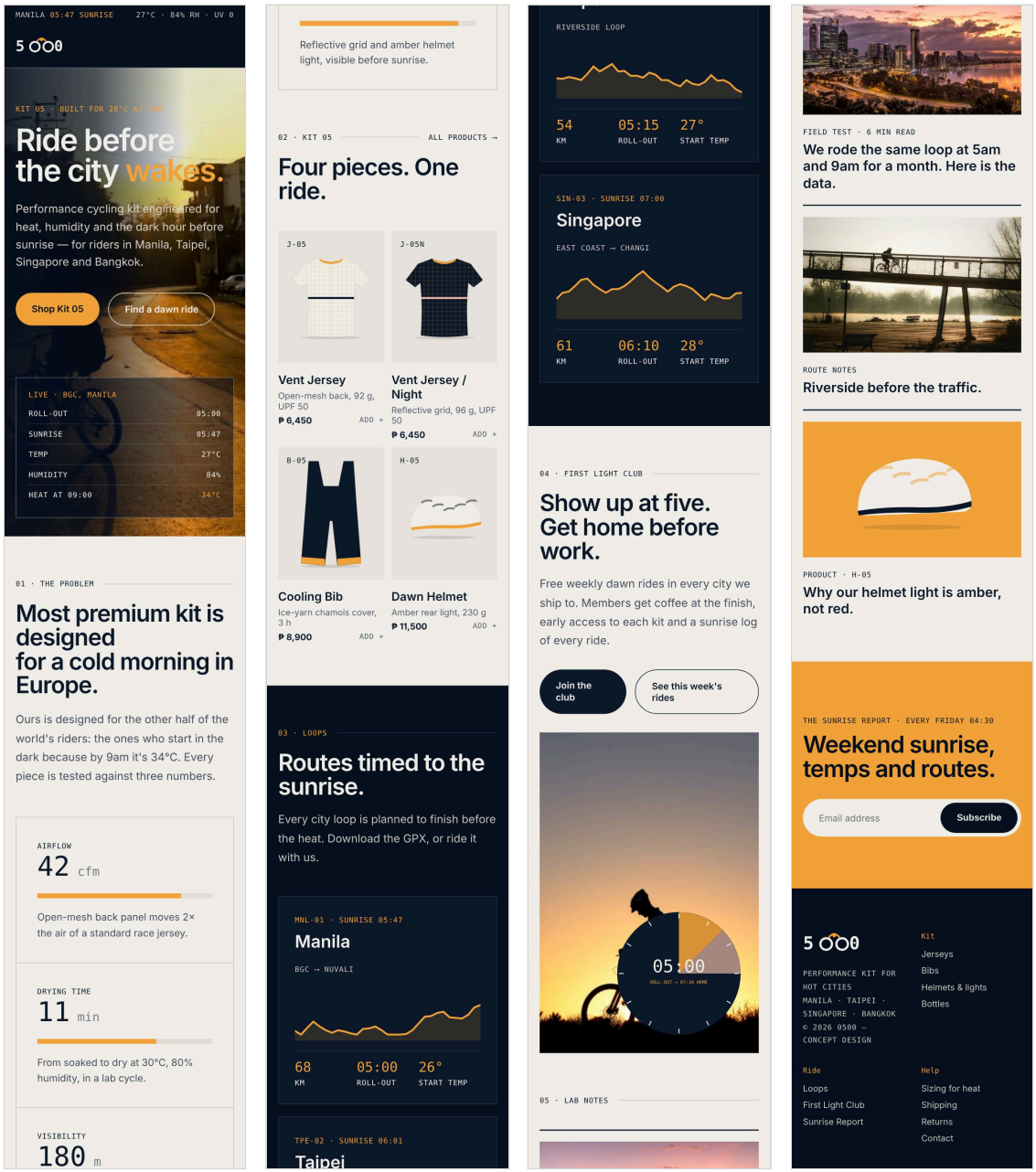
Kit 05: four products with part codes (J-05, B-05, H-05), specs and prices in pesos.

Loops: Manila, Taipei and Singapore routes with elevation profile, roll-out and sunrise times.

First Light Club with a 05:00 clock graphic; lab notes; the Sunrise Report sign-up; night footer.

CONCEPT 03 · SENIOR CREATIVE DIRECTION · WEBSITE · MOBILE 390 PX

0500 — mobile homepage

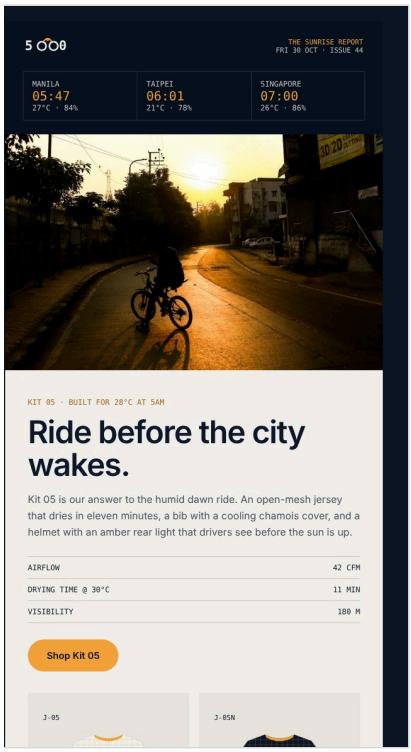


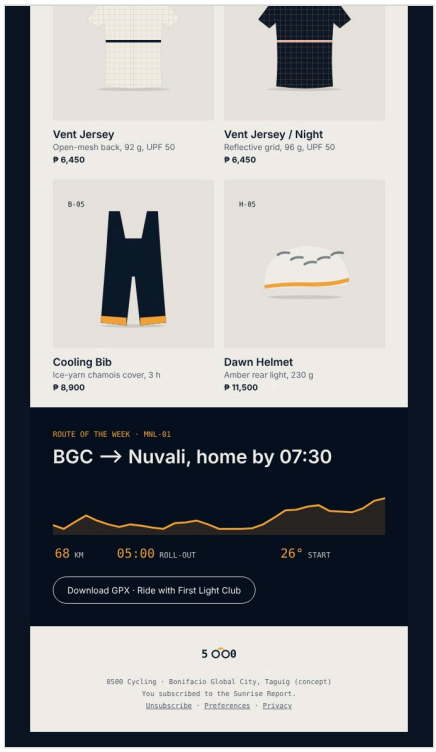
Homepage at 390 px mobile, full scroll in four strips (no horizontal overflow)

On mobile the readout panel drops below the headline, instruments stack, the kit grid stays two-up and the loops become a vertical list.

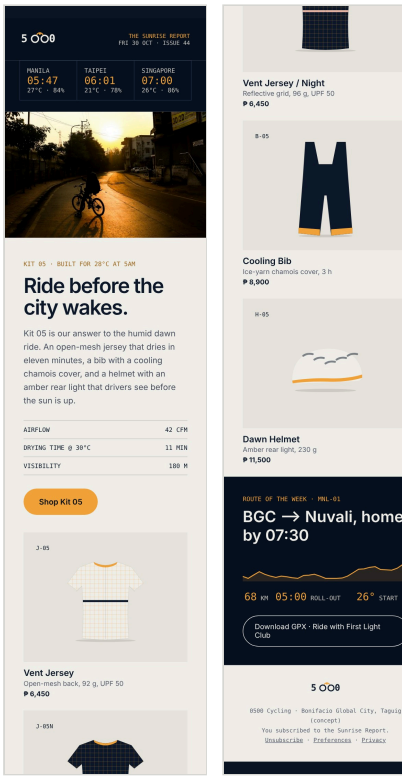
CONCEPT 03 · SENIOR CREATIVE DIRECTION · EMAIL · 600 PX

0500 — matching email





Desktop client (680 px window), two halves



Mobile 390 px

Same data, same look: night header with logo, the three-city sunrise/temperature table, dawn skyline, amber pill CTA, mono spec table.

Structure: header → city table → dawn hero → headline + story → three spec rows → "Shop Kit 05" → 2×2 kit → Route of the week with profile and GPX link → footer.

Practical: weekly cadence (Friday 04:30) gives a reason to open beyond selling. The city table could be personalised by subscriber city.

REVIEW

Comparison and recommendation

My design assessment out of 10 — not market data

Criterion	01 ORDRE	02 SLIPSTREAM	03 0500
Brand distinctiveness	6	9	9
Luxury perception	9	6	7
Cycling relevance	8	8	9
Commercial usability	8	6	8
Website experience	8	7	8
Email consistency	9	9	9
Target audience clarity	7	8	9
Scalability	8	7	8
Average (equal weight)	**7.9**	**7.5**	**8.4**

01 · ORDRE — 7.9

The most luxurious and the easiest to trust. Its weakness is distinctiveness: quiet European luxury is already owned by Rapha's premium lines, Pas Normal Studios and Café du Cycliste, so it would compete on execution alone.

02 · SLIPSTREAM — 7.5

The most ownable and the most fun, with a built-in community loop (crews, points, chapters). The black-and-white version is far more refined than the first, but it is still the least luxurious, depends on ongoing story output, and risks feeling like a fandom product to older, higher-spending riders.

03 · 0500 — 8.4

The clearest gap in the market and the clearest customer. Its claims are functional (heat, drying, visibility), so it must be backed by real testing before launch; until then the figures in this concept are placeholders.

Recommendation: develop 03 · 0500. It is not the most dramatic option, but it answers a real, unserved need, gives every channel a reason to exist (sunrise times, loops, weekly report) and can grow city by city. Two things worth borrowing: ORDRE's repair-for-life promise to build trust, and SLIPSTREAM's crew system as a later community layer (city crews for the First Light Club).

Next steps

Validate the heat-and-humidity problem with 10–15 dawn riders in Manila · commission a photo test at 05:00 in BGC · prototype the Vent Jersey and measure drying time · build the Sunrise Report as a real Klaviyo/Mailchimp template and test in Gmail, Outlook and Apple Mail.

CREDITS

Photography credits

All photos from Unsplash, used under the Unsplash License · captured 30 Oct 2026

Photo	Photographer	Source	Used in
Matte black road bike, studio	Mikkel Bech	unsplash.com · photo-1532298229144-0ec0c57515c7	01 hero, 01 email
Bronze road bike, timber wall	Dmitrii Vaccinium	unsplash.com · photo-1576435728678-68d0fbf94e91	01 bicycle section
Rider on a mountain road at dusk	Urban Vintage	unsplash.com · photo-1471506480208-91b3a4cc78be	01 journal
Bar tape and stem, black and white	Josh Nuttall	unsplash.com · photo-1497515098781-e965764ab601	01 atelier story
Two riders on a coast road	Coen van de Broek	unsplash.com · photo-1541625602330-2277a4c46182	01 Le Cercle, 01 email
Rider on a neon street at night	Fumiaki Hayashi	unsplash.com · photo-1758957097813-9b391db18caa	02 hero panel, rides, email
Riders sprinting, motion blur	charlie dt	unsplash.com · photo-1775638946697-fb4b8bb1dc88	02 Chapter 01
Bunch of road racers	Markus Spiske	unsplash.com · photo-1517649763962-0c623066013b	02 stat panel, rides
Lone rider, night motion blur	Samantha Gilmore	unsplash.com · photo-1729767616557-3b29c5e08a1e	02 next chapter, email
Rider crossing a lit square at night	Maciej Maciantowicz	unsplash.com · photo-1779136134245-66a65cb6ff3f	02 rides
Rider on an empty street at sunrise	Ish Consul	unsplash.com · photo-1722417209617-968559dcab0b	03 hero, 03 email
City skyline at first light	Eddie Mark Blair	unsplash.com · photo-1662673053425-924b45c185d0	03 lab notes
Rider on a footbridge at dawn	David Levêque	unsplash.com · photo-1703011558551-49118c9901aa	03 lab notes
Rider silhouetted at sunrise	Sina Sadeqi	unsplash.com · photo-1600596747748-9888ce1bc338	03 First Light Club

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SOURCES

All references

Accessed 30 October 2026

Item	Source	Type
Rapha homepage captures (5)	rapha.cc	Actual reference · screenshot
MAAP homepage capture	maap.cc	Actual reference · screenshot
Aman, Four Seasons, Rosewood captures	Batch 1 PDF (aman.com, fourseasons.com, rosewoodhotels.com)	Actual reference · screenshot
Hermès, Louis Vuitton, Four Seasons emails	emaillove.com/?p=1627662 · ?p=1624180 · four-seasons-20	Actual reference · description only
Wind Breaker background and status	Wikipedia · Anime Explained · Mein-MMO	Text sources
Lifestyle and bicycle photography in Concepts 01–03	Unsplash (see Photography credits); converted to manga screentone for Concept 02	Free-license photo, edited
Logos, emblems, crew glyphs, apparel tech flats, layouts, websites and emails	Created for this study	New original design

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